

While it's perfectly okay to buy a couple dish towels and kitchen utensils, here are some registry tricks to help you save on some of the bigger items too:

- **Shop the registry elsewhere** – Look at the registry items, but don't feel obligated to buy from that specific store. If they're registered at a place like Bed Bath & Beyond, Macy's, or Target, you can often find the same item for less on Amazon.
For instance, a Keurig K10 Mini Plus Brewing System costs \$79.99 at the big box store, but the same exact model on Amazon rings in at \$65.98. That's a \$14.01 difference! Just make sure to call the store and have them remove the item from the registry if you do this.
- **Take advantage of a sale** – When you know what stores are on a specific registry, immediately sign up for the store's mailing list and check often to see what sales and coupons they're offering. Sometimes you'll get lucky and be able to snag the winning item for a lot less.
- **Combine forces with friends or family members** – It's always nice to get some of the bigger items like a KitchenAid mixer for the bride, or a car seat for the expecting mama, but if it's not in your budget, grab a few friends or family members and combine your buying power. The benefits are two-fold: the recipient crosses some major items off her wish list, and you have less to think about when shopping for them.

3. MAKE THOUGHTFUL DIY GIFTS

One look through Pinterest, and you'll find hundreds, if not thousands, of gifts you can make for the new mom, bride, or graduate. The possibilities are as limitless as your creativity!

Here are some ideas to get your creative juices flowing.

For Baby: